

security have some very good features. Specifically the e-mail application does a lot for the mobile user: e-mail search function, disabling polling while roaming, having HTML e-mail out of the box and Exchange Server 2007 support with advanced features such as viewing the status of meeting attendees. For the business user, the improved security, when used correctly, provides a very decent security level out-of-the-box, providing many road warriors and IT-managers a piece of mind. Availability of Office Mobile on all WinMo devices, Windows Live integration with a much needed Windows Live Messenger overhaul, Windows Live push email support, and Internet Sharing utility to use you Windows Mobile phone as a wireless modem are some other USP's of Windows Mobile 6.

Even with all of these features, we appreciate WM6 most for what it doesn't do, i.e., randomly crash or hang when performing routine tasks. WM6 rarely freezes, and opening and closing applications is surprisingly fast when compared to some Symbian variants. For our overview, we will be focusing on Windows Mobile Standard Edition. The main difference between this and Windows Mobile Professional Edition is in the Office Mobile implementation. Where you can create documents in Professional edition, Standard edition just allows you to view and gives some light editing capability.

4.3.1 User interface and Today screen

Windows Mobile 6 has the glass look and feel of Windows Vista with its similar colour scheme and eye-pleasing icon and larger fonts. The user interface is aesthetically pleasing. This isn't just eye candy. They make the Smartphone OS look less intimidating and more approachable for an average-Joe. The top row of the Today screen is lined with icons that correspond to your most recently used applications. Below that, you'll find information such as time and date. Then there is a

search bar also which comes in very handy. It enables you to launch a Web search without having to open the browser. Scrolling beneath the search bar you'll see upcoming appointments, as well as the number of unread messages. Of course, you can customise the background image, colour scheme, and backlight time.

Nine new email shortcuts so you can easily reply, delete, move messages, and more

One of the biggest complaints about Windows Mobile devices is the number of steps it takes to perform a simple task, such as closing a program. This is still pretty much true of Windows Mobile 6, but Microsoft has taken some steps to ease the pain. For example, the company has added nine new e-mail shortcuts so you can easily reply,



Today's Screen on Windows Mobile 6 Platform